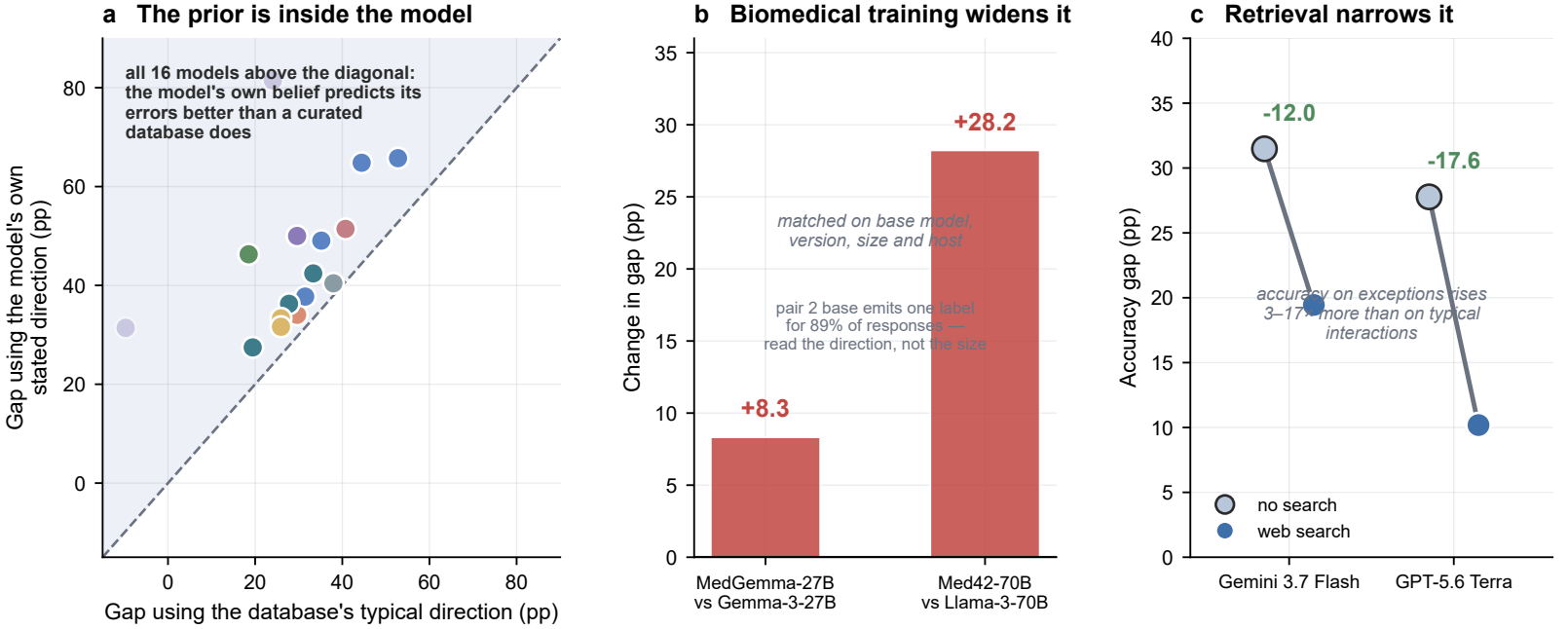

a The prior is inside the model
all 16 models above the diagonal: the model's own belief predicts its errors better than a curated database does
Gap using the model's own stated direction (pp)
Gap using the database's typical direction (pp)
0
20
40
60
80
b Biomedical training widens it
Change in gap (pp)
0
5
10
15
20
25
30
35
+8.3
+28.2
matched on base model, version, size and host
pair 2 base emits one label for 89% of responses — read the direction, not the size
MedGemma-27B vs Gemma-3-27B
Med42-70B vs Llama-3-70B
c Retrieval narrows it
Accuracy gap (pp)
0
5
10
15
20
25
30
35
40
-12.0
-17.6
accuracy on exceptions rises 3–17× more than on typical interactions
no search
web search
Gemini 3.7 Flash
GPT-5.6 Terra